PUNCTUATION

Punctuation Mark	Name	Example Sentence
.	Full Stop / Period	She is reading a book.
,	Comma	I bought apples, bananas, and grapes.
;	Semicolon	I have a meeting tomorrow; however, I might join later.
:	Colon	These are my hobbies: reading, writing, and painting.
?	Question Mark	How are you today?
!	Exclamation Mark	Wow! That's amazing!
-	Hyphen	This is a well-known story.
–	En Dash	The India–Pakistan match starts at 7 PM.
—	Em Dash	He was running late—very late—for the exam.
'	Apostrophe	It's a beautiful day.
" "	Quotation Marks	She said, "I love learning."
' '	Single Quotation Marks	He called it 'the best day of his life.'

PUNCTUATION

Punctuation marks are used to convey the meaning or idea expressed in a sentence.

1. a. Let us eat grandmother.

b. Let us eat, grandmother.

2. a. Hang him, not let him free.

b. Hang him not, let him free.

3. a. I love baking, my friends and family.

b. I love baking my friends and family.

4. a. A woman, without her man, is nothing.

b. A woman: without her, man is nothing.

1. FULL STOP / PERIOD (.)

b) Period

It is used at the end of a sentence that marks the end of a sentence.

Ex.

a. **He did the work on time.**
b. **The students were working.**
c. **Bring a glass of water.**

2. QUESTION MARK (?)

What, Why, How

It is used at the end of a sentence to ask a question.

Ex.

verb ~ sub ?

a. What are you doing?

b. Will you help me?

c. Did she come on time?

Note:

a. He asked me, “What are you doing?” (Direct)

b. He asked me what I was doing. (Indirect)

3. EXCLAMATION MARK (!)

It is used to express strong / sudden feeling of joy, surprise or sorrow. It is also used to put emphasis.

Ex.

a. Wow! What a great victory.

b. Ah! I am ruined.

c. Bravo! The players performed well.

d. What a beautiful scene!

e. How fool he is!

3. EXCLAMATION MARK (!)

Note:

Exclamation marks are also used for warnings or to make sentence forceful.

Ex.

a. Watch out!

b. Be careful!

c. Help! Help!

d. Go to bed now!

3. EXCLAMATION MARK (!)

😀 Happiness / Excitement

- Wow!
- Yay!
- Hurray!
- Awesome!
- Great!
- Fantastic!
- Wonderful!
- Excellent!
- Congratulations!
- Bravo!

😳 Surprise / Shock

- Oh!
- What!
- Really!
- No way!
- Unbelievable!
- Incredible!
- Whoa!
- Oh no!
- Oh dear!

😡 Anger / Warning

- Stop!
- Enough!
- Quiet!
- Shut up!
- Wait!
- Don't!
- Never!
- Get out!
- Watch out!

3. EXCLAMATION MARK (!)

😢 Sorrow / Sadness

- Alas!
- Oh no!
- Poor me!
- Why!
- What a pity!
- How sad!
- Oh dear!
- Gone!
- Lost!
- My God!
- So tragic!
- No!
- Too late!

😨 Fear / Urgency

- Help!
- Fire!
- Run!
- Danger!
- Look out!
- Hurry!
- Save me!
- Oh God!

4. COMMA (,)

It denotes a short pause.

1. Comma (,) is used to separate three or more words, phrases or clauses written in series.

Ex.

a. **He loves ice-cream chocolates and books. (Incorrect)**

b. **He loves ice-cream and chocolates and books. (Incorrect)**

c. **He loves ice-cream, chocolates and books. (correct)**

4. COMMA (,)

Conjunction vs Comma

Although he worked hard yet he failed.

Although he worked hard, he failed.

4. COMMA (,)

2. Use of comma with co-ordinating conjunctions like AND, OR, SO, BUT, THEREFORE, HOWEVER.

Note.

All these conjunctions take commas only when there are two independent clauses.

4. COMMA (,)

a. I like samosas and pastries.

b. I have spoken to her, and she has confirmed the news.

c. He worked hard but failed.

d. He worked hard, but he failed.

e. I like candy, but I am allergic to it.

f. Nothing but some books was available.

g. He was late. But, I waited for her.

h. My sister was sick, so I took her to the hospital.

I. My sister was sick. So, I took her to the hospital.

4. COMMA (,)

Note: Dependent clauses take comma.

1. When he comes, I will go.

2. Although he worked hard, he failed.

3. In case it rains, I will take an umbrella.

4. COMMA (,)

3. Use of comma with Appositives

Ex.

1. Kalidas, a great poet, was loved by all.

2. My friend, Ram, helped me to do the work.

3. I, as a teacher of English, was teaching grammar.

4. COMMA (,)

4. Use of commas with days / dates / months

Ex.

a. He was born on 4th July, 1987.

b. He was born in July, 1987.

c. He was born on Sunday, 4th July, 1987.

d. He lives in Chennai, Tamilnadu.

e. He lives in Delhi, India.

4. COMMA (,)

5 . Comma is used with introductory prepositional phrases.

Ex.

a. During the war, there was immense bloodshed.

b. He was present at the time of opening ceremony.

c. At the time of opening ceremony, he was present.

4. COMMA (,)

Note:

Comma is also used to introduce a subject.

Ex.

a. This is my friend, Jane.

b. Ram, will you help me?

Ram will help me

. ? ! ,

PUNCTUATION
PART 02

Q.1 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.

The Prime Minister, a great _____ impressed the audience.

1. orator;

2. orator,

3. Orator

4. orator:

Q.2 Select the option that uses the correct punctuation marks for the given sentence.

She exclaimed, sharply, _____.

1. "You"

2. You?

3. "You!

4. "You!"

3. Select the option that uses the correct punctuation marks for the given sentence.

"How do you know my _____ "she asked.

1. secret!

2. age.

3. name?

4. address;

Q.4 Select the option with the correct punctuation mark for the given sentence.

Get out I don't want to see you again.

1. Get out, I don't want to see you again
2. Get out: I don't want to see you again
3. Get out! I don't want to see you again.
4. Get out; I don't want to see you again.

5. Where did you put my keys___

1. ,

2. :

3. ?

4. .

6. James Strand had been arrested on the 17th ____

1. day of december; at Edinburgh
2. day of december: at Edinburgh
3. day of December, at Edinburgh
4. day of December! at edinburgh

Q.7 Select the option that correctly punctuates the given sentence.

If you have received this communication in error please notify us by reply e-mail.

1. If you have received, this communication in error please notify us by reply e-mail!

2. If you have received, this communication in error, please notify us by reply e-mail.

3. If you have received this communication in error, please notify us by reply e-mail.

4. If you have received this communication in error: please notify us by reply e-mail.

8. Choose the correct set of punctuation marks to be used in the given sentence.

Alas friend (i)____ Our hearts are not inside us (ii)___.

1. (i) hyphen, (ii) comma

2. (i) exclamation mark, (ii) dash

3. (i) quotation marks, (ii) comma

4. (1) exclamation mark, (ii) period

9. Select the option that uses the correct punctuation marks for the given sentence.

_____ won the last match.

1. **Hurray, we**
2. **Hurray! We**
3. **Hurray! We,**
4. **Hurray. We,**

10. Select the option that uses the correct punctuation marks for the given sentence.

Little by _____ my difficulties began to disappear.

1. **little, however,**
2. **little however**
3. **little, however**
4. **little however,**

11. Select the correctly punctuated form of the given sentence.

Peel the carrots chop them and then put them in the pan

1. Peel the carrots, chop them, and then, put them in the pan.
2. Peel the carrots, chop them and then put them in the pan.
3. Peel the carrots, chop them, and then put them in the pan.
4. Peel the carrots chop them and then put them in the pan.

- Words like *however, in fact, moreover, and then* are often set off by commas because they **interrupt the flow** of the sentence.

12. Select the most appropriate punctuation to fill in the blank.

What a huge house this is ___

1. ‘(single quotation mark)

2. . (period)

3. ! (exclamation mark)

4.? (question mark)

13. Select the most appropriate punctuation mark to fill in the blank.

Did you realise what wrong have you done to him _

1. ‘

2. ?

3. !

4. .

14. Select the correctly punctuated sentence from the following options.

1. When in Rome do, as the Romans do.

2. When in Rome do as the Romans, do.

3. When in Rome, do as the Romans do.

4. When in, Rome do as the Romans do.

15. Which of the following sentences is wrongly punctuated?

1. Have you had your dinner?

2. "I am fine," said Ram.

3. What a terrible fire this is!

4. He enquired whether I had finished my work?

16. Which of the following sentences is wrongly punctuated?

1. High and low, rich and poor, wise and foolish must die.

2. He lost land, money, reputation and friends.

3. Pandit Nehru, the first Prime Minister of India, died in 1964.

4. He did not, however, gain his object.

17. Punctuate the following sentence correctly:

men may come and men may go but I go on forever

a. Men may come and men may go, but I go on forever.

b. Men may come, and men may go, but I go on forever.

c. Men may come, and men, may go but I go on forever.

d. Men may come and men may go, but, I go on, forever.

18. Punctuate the following sentence correctly:

I therefore request to grant me leave

a . I, therefore, request to grant me leave.
b. I therefore, request to grant me leave.
c. I therefore request, to grant me leave.
d. I therefore request to grant, me leave.

19. Punctuate the following sentence correctly:

I like all things good and bad beautiful and ugly dark and bright

a. I like all things good and bad, beautiful and ugly; dark and bright

b. I like all things good and bad, beautiful and ugly, dark and bright.

c. I like all things good and bad; beautiful and ugly, dark and bright.

d. I like all things, good and bad; beautiful and ugly; dark and bright.

20 .Choose the sentence that is correctly punctuated-

1. The manager said to Arun," are you willing to work as an accountant in this office at such a low salary."

2. The manager said to arun," are you willing to work as an accountant in this office at such a low salary?"

3. The manager said to Arun, "Are you willing to work as an accountant in this office at such a low salary."

4. The manager said to Arun, "Are you willing to work as an accountant in this office at such a low salary?"

21. Observe the punctuation marks and select the correct sentence.

(A) "perhaps" cried he, "there may be such monsters as you describe"

(B) "Perhaps", cried he, "there may be such monsters as you describe !"

(C) Perhaps, cried he "there may be such monsters as you describe"

(D) Perhaps cried he, "there may be such monsters as you describe".

Generally, **"perhaps" is not followed by an exclamation mark** in normal writing, because it is a word that indicates uncertainty or possibility, and exclamation marks are usually used to show strong emotion (surprise, excitement, anger, etc.).

✅ Examples:

Perhaps we should leave early. (normal)

Perhaps it will rain today. (normal)

But in **informal writing or dialogue**, if you want to show surprise, excitement, or dramatic effect, you **can** use an exclamation mark with *perhaps*:

✨ Examples:

Perhaps! (showing sudden realization or dramatic tone)

"Will you join us tomorrow?" — "Perhaps!"

👉 So, the rule is:

Formal/academic writing → Avoid using *perhaps!* with an exclamation mark.

Creative/informal writing (stories, dialogue, casual messages) → You can use *perhaps!* for emphasis.

22. Observe the punctuation marks and select the correct sentence.

(A) All that I am, all that I hope to be, I owe to my angel mother.

(B) All that I am; all that I hope to be, I owe to my angel mother!

(C) All that I am, all that I hope to be; I owe to my angel mother.

(D) All that I am - all that I hope to be; I owe to my angel. mother.

23. Identify the grammatically acceptable sentence:

(A) How fine the weather is?

(B) How fine the weather is!

(C) How fine is the weather.

(D) How fine the weather is.

24. Which of the following is correctly punctuated?

(A) He said "Have a nice day Sir."

(B) He said, "have a nice day Sir!"

(C) He said, "Have a nice day, Sir."

(D) He said "Have a nice day Sir?"

👉 In English grammar, when you address someone directly by name, title, or term of respect, you separate it with a comma.

Examples:

Thank you, John.

Good morning, Madam.

Please sit down, Mr. Smith.

The comma signals that you are **speaking directly to the person**

25. Which of the following sentences correctly punctuated?

(A) Day said to Night, "I bring God's light".

(B) Day said to Night I bring God's light.

(C) Day said to Night “I bring God’s light”.

(D) Day said to Night, “I bring Gods light".

26. Pick out the grammatically acceptable sentence:

(A) Alas, the poor man is dead.

(B) Alas the poor man is dead!

(C) Alas! The poor man is dead.

(D) Alas, The poor man is dead.

27 . Which of the following sentences is correctly punctuated ?

(A) The speaker said, please, lend me your ears.

(B) The speaker said please, lend me your ears.

(C) The speaker said, "Please ! lend me your ears."

(D) The speaker said, "Please lend me your ears."

The word **“please”** can take either a **period (.)** or an **exclamation mark (!)** depending on the **tone** you want to show.

✅ **Polite / formal request → use a period**

Please sit down.

Please send me the report by tomorrow.

✅ **Strong request, urgency, pleading, or emotion → use an exclamation mark**

Please stop! (urgent)

Please, don’t go! (emotional)

Please help me! (desperate)

⚠️ But in **formal writing** (like letters, essays, office emails), it’s better to avoid “please!” with an exclamation mark, because it can sound too emotional or demanding. Instead, keep it with a period.

👉 Rule of thumb:

Everyday polite use → **period**

Emotional/urgent/dramatic tone → **exclamation mark**

28. Select the correctly punctuated sentence in this group

(a) My favorite teacher, who just happens to be my uncle, retired from the university last summer.

(b) My favorite teacher who just happens to be my uncle, retired from the university last summer.

(c) My favorite teacher, who just happens to be my uncle retired from the university last summer.

(d) My favourite, teacher, who just happens to be my uncle, retired from the university last summer.

29. a) After finishing his dinner, John asked, "Have you had your dinner yet?"

b) After finishing his dinner, John asked "Have you had your dinner yet"?

c) After finishing his dinner John asked, "Have you had your dinner yet?"

d) After finishing his dinner John asked "Have you had your dinner yet"?

PUNCTUATION
PART 03

5. COLON (:)

1. It is used to introduce a list of things in a series or to give examples.

Ex.

1. There are three types of muscles: skeletal, cardiac and smooth.
2. The three types of muscles are: skeletal, cardiac and smooth. (incorrect)
3. The three types of muscles are as follows:

a. cardiac

b. skeletal

c. smooth

4. There are three types of muscles.

For example: cardiac, smooth and skeletal

5. COLON (:)

Note.

1. I have visited places like Mumbai, Chennai and Dehradun

2. I have visited places such as Mumbai, Chennai and Dehradun

5. COLON (:)

2. Colons are used to mention the time of a day and in mathematical expressions to denote ratio.

Ex.

1. I came at 7:30 pm.

2. The ratio of milk to water is 1:3.

5. COLON (:)

3. In dialogue writing

a. Teacher: Why didn't you help him?

Student: I was not present there.

6. SEMICOLON (;)

It is used to link two independent clauses which are related to each other. It also indicates a pause. (much longer than a comma)

Ex.

a. He painted the kitchen; he still needs to paint the bedroom.

b. We went shopping; we bought milk.

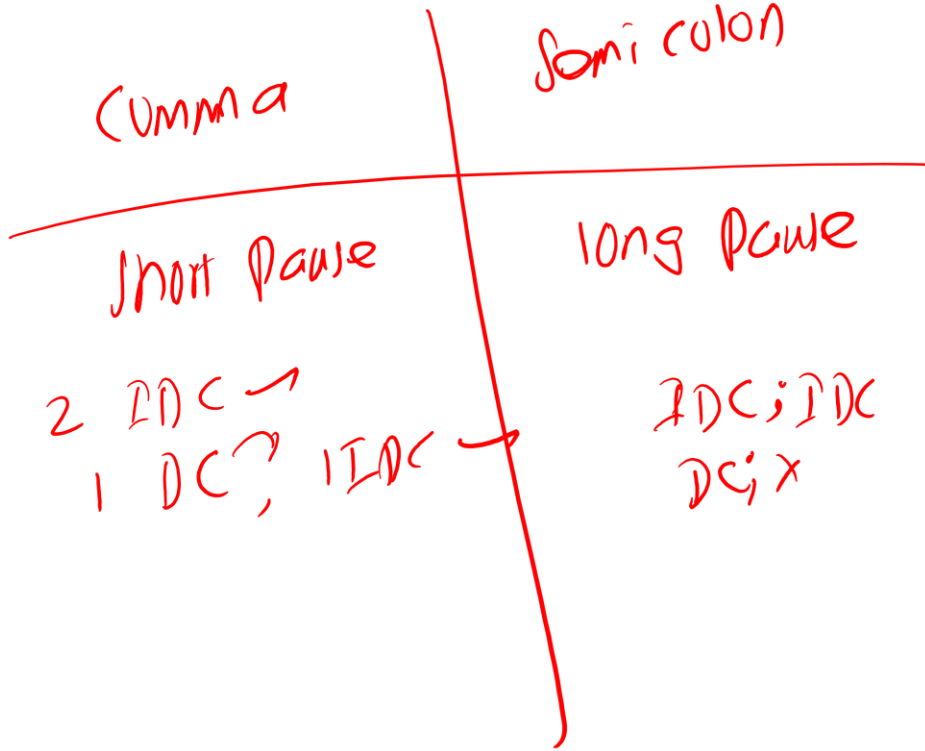
CONFUSION IN THE USE OF COMMA AND SEMICOLON

1. Comma can be used in dependent sentences but semicolon cannot be used.

Ex.

a. If he works, he will succeed.

b. If he works; he will succeed.



CONFUSION IN THE USE OF COMMA AND SEMICOLON

2. With coordinating conjunctions, we use comma and not semicolon.

Ex.

a. She was sitting in the library, but she was not reading.

b. She was sitting in the library; she was not reading.

; but ✗ and, so, or, but, → ; ✗

CONFUSION IN THE USE OF COMMA AND SEMICOLON

3. Semicolons also function as commas when separating items or phrases in complex lists.

Ex.

a. **We took a road trip to Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh, Kolkata, West Bengal and Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh.**

b. **We took a road trip to Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh; Kolkata, West Bengal ; and Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh.**

7. HYPHEN (-)

It is used to make compound words. (Compound nouns and Compound adjectives).

Ex.

a. Mother – in – law

b. Commander – in – chief

c. Passer - by

d. She is a two – year – old child.

e. Their relationship is short – lived.

f. He is a well – known actor.

C. Noun

C. Adj

8. DASH (__)

1. To denote a range (number / time)

Ex.

a. 1960 – 1980

b. 6pm – 7pm

Note.

1. A dash is used to indicate a break or extra information while a hyphen is used to combine words

2. Dash can be used in place of comma, colon and semicolon but a hyphen cannot be used.

8. DASH (__)

a. People, both young and old, were advised to take vaccinations.

b. People -- both young and old -- were advised to take vaccinations.

Note.

en dash - (-) denotes a range (to)

em dash - (—) break / extra information.

9. PARENTHESIS (())

It is used to give additional information and is not a part of the sentence.

1. Diwali (my favourite festival) is around the corner.

2. The World Health Organisation (WHO) refused to comment on the allegations.

3. Einstein (1879 – 1955) was one of the greatest scientific minds.

PUNCTUATION
PART 04

1. Select the most appropriate punctuation mark to fill in the blank.

The following are the items we require for the culinary workshop ___ raw ingredients, oven and gloves.

1. : (colon)

3. . (full stop)

2. ’ (apostrophe)

4. , (comma)

2. Select the most appropriate punctuation to fill in the blank.

Group discussions are usually held on topics of four kinds_____

(a) factual

(b) social or political

(c) abstract

(d) case study based

1.;

3.!

2. .

4. :

3. Select the option that uses the correct punctuation marks for the given sentence.

There are three types of muscles in the ____ smooth, and skeletal.

1. **body: cardiac**
2. **body; cardiac,**
3. **body: cardiac,**
4. **body- cardiac**

4. Select the option that uses the correct punctuation marks for the given sentence.

The municipal government is funding a ____ education system.

1. community, based

2. community-based

3. community based,

4. community; based

5. Select the most appropriate punctuation to fill in the blank.

The chef mixed sugar and coco powder in

1 ___ 1 ratio for the cake.

1. : (colon)
2. ; (semicolon)
3. ? (question mark)
4. . (period)

6. Select the option that uses the correct punctuation marks for the given sentence.

My niece was planning to learn three ____ animation, and digital marketing.

1. skills: data mining,

2 skills; data mining,

3. skills- data mining

4. skills! data mining,

7. Select the most appropriate punctuation mark to fill in the blank.

John is an avid traveller _____ he has visited over 20 countries in the past five years.

1. Semi-colon (;)

2. Period (.)

3. Colon (:)

4. Comma (,)

8. Observe the punctuation marks and select the correct sentence.

(A) The Human mind is never stationary; it advances or retrogrades.

(B) The Human mind is never stationary, it advances or retrogrades.

(C) The Human mind is never stationary it advances, or retrogrades.

(D) The Human mind is never stationary it advances or retrogrades!

9. Correctly punctuated sentence is -

(a) The other boy (Mukul (alias Munna) was there.

(b) The other boy (Mukul [alias Munna]) was there.

(c) The other boy [Mukul (alias munna)] was there.

(d) Two brackets are not used in a single sentence.

10. Punctuate the following sentence:

The creator answered yes but by accepting the burden you will show your greatness of heart. Find out the correct one.

(a) The creator answered "Yes but by accepting the burden you will show your greatness of heart."

(b) The creator answered "Yes". But by accepting the burden you will show your greatness of heart.

(c) The Creator answered, "Yes, but by accepting the burden you will show your greatness of heart."

(d) None of these

11. Select the option in which punctuation mark is appropriately used. :

Ashoka having conquered Kalinga began to hate war.

1. Ashoka, having conquered Kalinga, began to hate war.

2. Ashoka, having conquered, Kalinga began to hate war.

3. Ashoka having conquered Kalinga, began to hate war.

4. Ashoka, having conquered Kalinga began to hate, war.

12. Which sentence has the correct punctuation?

1. Sarah studying German; Physics and Chemistry this year.
2. Sarah's studying German, Physics and Chemistry this year.
3. Sarah's studying German: Physics and Chemistry this year.
4. Sarah's studying German Physics Chemistry this year.

's → is, was, had

13. Choose the sentence that uses quotation marks correctly:

"The teacher said, 'Today's lesson is on punctuation,' and everyone paid attention."

a. The teacher said "Today's lesson is on punctuation" and everyone paid attention.

b. The teacher said, "Today's lesson is on punctuation, and everyone paid attention."

c. The teacher said, "Today's lesson is on punctuation" and everyone paid attention.

d. The teacher said "Today's lesson is on punctuation, and everyone paid attention."

14. A) I did not receive the order; therefore, I will not pay my bill.

B) I did not receive the order: Therefore I will not pay my bill.

C) I did not receive the order; therefore; I will not pay my bill.

D) I did not receive the order, therefore; I will not pay my bill.

1. I did not receive the order, so I will not pay my bill.
2. I did not receive the order, but I still have to pay my bill.
3. I did not receive the order, and I will not pay my bill.
4. I did not receive the order, or I will not pay my bill.
5. I did not receive the order; therefore, I will not pay my bill.
6. She studied hard; consequently, she passed the exam.
7. We wanted to go out; however, it started raining

✅ semicolon + conjunctive adverb + comma rule applies with

also, besides, furthermore, moreover, accordingly, consequently, hence, therefore, thus, as a result, however, nevertheless, nonetheless, still, instead, conversely, on the other hand, likewise, similarly, indeed, in fact, certainly, afterward, eventually, finally, meanwhile, next, now, then, all in all, in conclusion, in summary, on the whole

❌ We do **not** use a semicolon before co-ordinating conjunctions *and, or, but, so*.

15.

A) No you cannot stay out late tonight.

B) No, you cannot stay out, late, tonight.

C) No, you cannot stay out late tonight.

D) No you cannot stay, out late, tonight.



THANK YOU